

IBEW Aptitude Test Reading Comprehension

READING COMPREHENSION Exam 18

Part A — Passages and Questions

Time Limit: 51 Minutes

Passage 1

A regional facilities department recently changed how it handles requests for room temperature adjustments. Previously, employees called the front desk when a work area felt too warm or too cold. The front desk then passed the message to maintenance staff. During busy periods, some requests were delayed or repeated because there was no single record of the issue.

The department introduced an online comfort request form. Employees now enter the room number, the concern, the time the issue was noticed, and whether the problem affects a large area or a single workspace. Maintenance staff review the requests several times a day and check whether multiple reports are coming from the same area.

Managers say the new process helps identify patterns, such as repeated complaints from one section of the building. It also allows maintenance staff to respond in a more organized way.

RC18-001

Question: What is the main idea of the passage?

- A) Employees should stop reporting temperature problems.
 - B) An online request form improved how temperature concerns are tracked and handled.
 - C) The front desk now repairs heating and cooling equipment.
 - D) Room temperature problems cannot be solved.
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RC18-002

Question: What problem existed under the old process?

- A) Maintenance staff received too many written reports.
- B) Some requests were delayed or repeated because there was no single record.
- C) Employees were not allowed to call the front desk.

D) Temperature concerns were always solved immediately.

RC18-003

Question: What information must employees enter on the online form?

- A) Room number, concern, time noticed, and size of affected area
 - B) Employee pay rate and vacation balance
 - C) Customer order number and delivery time
 - D) Parking location and vehicle color
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RC18-004

Question: Why do maintenance staff check whether multiple reports come from the same area?

- A) To avoid responding to building problems
 - B) To decide which employees should move offices
 - C) To identify patterns in temperature concerns
 - D) To replace the online form with phone calls
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RC18-005

Question: The word “patterns” most nearly means:

- A) Repeated signs or trends
 - B) Random decorations
 - C) Private messages
 - D) Completed repairs
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Passage 2

NOTICE

Beginning January 8, employees who use the shared print room must clear paper jams only if they have been trained to do so. Employees who are not trained should place an “out of service” sign on the machine and contact Office Support.

The updated procedure was created after several printers were damaged when users pulled stuck paper from the wrong area. The purpose is to reduce equipment damage and make sure problems are handled safely.

Office Support will offer short printer-care training sessions next week for employees who regularly use the print room.

RC18-006

Question: What is the purpose of the notice?

- A) To announce a new printer-use procedure related to paper jams
 - B) To close the shared print room permanently
 - C) To require all employees to repair printers
 - D) To explain changes to office furniture
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RC18-007

Question: What should untrained employees do if a printer has a paper jam?

- A) Pull the paper from any opening.
 - B) Ignore the printer and continue using it.
 - C) Place an “out of service” sign on the machine and contact Office Support.
 - D) Move the printer to another room.
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RC18-008

Question: Why was the procedure updated?

- A) Printers were being damaged when users removed stuck paper incorrectly.
- B) Employees stopped using paper.
- C) Office Support no longer worked with printers.
- D) The print room had too many signs.

RC18-009

Question: Who will be offered printer-care training sessions?

- A) Customers who visit the building
 - B) Employees who regularly use the print room
 - C) Delivery drivers only
 - D) Employees who never use printers
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Passage 3

Many companies use incident trend reviews to improve workplace safety. Instead of looking at each incident separately, managers review reports over a period of time to see whether certain types of problems are happening repeatedly.

For example, if several minor hand injuries occur in the same department, the company may review glove use, tool condition, training, or work pace. The goal is to understand why similar incidents continue to happen and what changes may reduce future risk.

Trend reviews are most useful when reports contain accurate details. If reports simply state that an employee “got hurt,” managers may not have enough information to identify a cause. Clear descriptions help turn individual reports into useful safety information.

RC18-010

Question: What is the main idea of the passage?

- A) Incident trend reviews help companies find repeated safety problems and reduce risk.
 - B) Safety reports should include as little information as possible.
 - C) Managers should examine incidents only one at a time.
 - D) Minor injuries do not need to be reported.
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RC18-011

Question: What does an incident trend review look for?

- A) Whether employees like their work schedules

- B) Whether certain types of problems are happening repeatedly
 - C) Whether customers understand invoices
 - D) Whether equipment colors match company signs
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RC18-012

Question: If several minor hand injuries occur in one department, what might the company review?

- A) Glove use, tool condition, training, or work pace
 - B) Customer delivery routes
 - C) Office decoration plans
 - D) Employee parking spaces
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RC18-013

Question: Why is the report description “got hurt” weak?

- A) It gives too much technical information.
 - B) It identifies the exact cause.
 - C) It may not provide enough information to identify a cause.
 - D) It explains the trend clearly.
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RC18-014

Question: Which conclusion is best supported by the passage?

- A) Accurate incident details can help managers prevent similar problems.
 - B) Trend reviews work best when reports are vague.
 - C) Similar incidents should never be compared.
 - D) Safety information is useful only after serious injuries.
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Passage 4

Before automatic irrigation timers became common, many public parks relied on workers to turn sprinkler systems on and off manually. This approach required staff time and could lead to uneven watering if schedules were missed or sprinklers were left running too long.

Automatic timers changed park maintenance by allowing watering schedules to be set in advance. Parks could water grass, plants, and athletic fields during early morning hours when evaporation was lower and fewer visitors were present. Timers also helped reduce overwatering by shutting systems off after a set period.

Modern irrigation systems may include moisture sensors or weather-based controls. Even with these improvements, workers still inspect sprinkler heads, pipes, and coverage patterns to make sure the system works properly.

RC18-015

Question: What is the main idea of the passage?

- A) Automatic irrigation timers improved watering efficiency but still require inspection.
 - B) Public parks no longer need water.
 - C) Workers should always leave sprinklers running all day.
 - D) Irrigation systems are used only inside buildings.
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RC18-016

Question: What was one problem with manual sprinkler operation?

- A) Parks could not grow grass.
 - B) Workers never watered athletic fields.
 - C) Schedules could be missed or sprinklers left running too long.
 - D) Sprinkler systems had no pipes.
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RC18-017

Question: Why might parks water during early morning hours?

- A) Evaporation is lower and fewer visitors are present.
- B) Sprinklers cannot work later in the day.

- C) Plants absorb no water after sunrise.
 - D) Workers are not allowed to inspect systems.
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RC18-018

Question: How is the passage organized?

- A) It lists rules for park visitors.
 - B) It explains an older method, a technological improvement, and current maintenance.
 - C) It compares irrigation systems with public transportation.
 - D) It argues that parks should remove athletic fields.
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Passage 5

A regional call center recently revised its training for handling customer complaints. The previous training focused mainly on finding the correct department or policy. While that information was useful, supervisors noticed that some employees sounded rushed or defensive when customers were upset.

The revised training teaches employees to listen carefully, confirm the customer's concern, and explain the next step clearly. Employees practice short role-play conversations in which they must respond calmly before transferring the call or entering a service request.

Supervisors report that customer follow-up surveys have improved since the training was revised. They believe customers are more satisfied when they feel their concern was understood, even if the problem cannot be solved immediately.

RC18-019

Question: What is the main idea of the passage?

- A) The call center stopped training employees.
 - B) Revised complaint training improved how employees communicate with upset customers.
 - C) Customers are no longer allowed to make complaints.
 - D) Employees now avoid explaining next steps.
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RC18-020

Question: What did the previous training focus on mainly?

- A) Finding the correct department or policy
 - B) Writing advertising messages
 - C) Repairing customer equipment
 - D) Scheduling employee vacations
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RC18-021

Question: What problem did supervisors notice?

- A) Employees sounded rushed or defensive with upset customers.
 - B) Customers never asked questions.
 - C) Employees refused to transfer calls.
 - D) Follow-up surveys were not used.
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RC18-022

Question: What do employees practice during revised training?

- A) Calmly responding during short role-play conversations
 - B) Avoiding customer concerns
 - C) Ending calls without explanation
 - D) Removing service requests from the system
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RC18-023

Question: The word “defensive” most nearly means:

- A) Calm and helpful
- B) Acting as if being criticized or attacked
- C) Completely silent
- D) Easy to understand

Passage 6

Many workplaces use color-coded tags to show the status of equipment. A green tag may show that equipment is ready for use, while a red tag may show that it should not be used until repaired or inspected. Other colors may identify items waiting for cleaning, testing, or supervisor approval.

Status tags help employees make quick decisions. Instead of guessing whether a tool or machine is available, workers can check the tag before using it. This can prevent mistakes, especially in busy areas where several similar items are stored together.

The system works only if tags are kept current. If a repaired item still has a red tag or a damaged item keeps a green tag, employees may receive the wrong message. Regular tag checks help keep the system reliable.

RC18-024

Question: What is the main idea of the passage?

- A) Color-coded tags can help identify equipment status when kept current.
- B) Equipment tags are useful only when they are missing.
- C) Workers should guess whether equipment is ready.
- D) Similar tools should never be stored together.

RC18-025

Question: What might a red tag show?

- A) Equipment should not be used until repaired or inspected.
- B) Equipment is ready for immediate use.
- C) Equipment has been cleaned and approved.
- D) Equipment belongs to a customer.

RC18-026

Question: How do status tags help employees?

- A) They make equipment harder to identify.

- B) They help workers make quick decisions about equipment use.
 - C) They replace all workplace training.
 - D) They prevent supervisors from inspecting tools.
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RC18-027

Question: What can happen if tags are not kept current?

- A) Employees may receive the wrong message about equipment status.
 - B) All equipment becomes safer automatically.
 - C) Similar items disappear from storage.
 - D) Repairs become unnecessary.
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RC18-028

Question: Which conclusion is best supported by the passage?

- A) A status-tag system is reliable only when tags accurately match equipment condition.
 - B) Red tags should always stay on repaired equipment.
 - C) Green tags should be used on damaged tools.
 - D) Color-coded tags create no benefit in busy areas.
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Passage 7

Many communities maintain public storm shelters in areas where severe weather can occur. These shelters are designed to give residents a safer place to go when conditions become dangerous. They may be located in schools, community centers, or specially built structures.

Clear public information is important because residents need to know where shelters are located, when they are open, and what items they should bring. Some shelters may not allow pets unless they are service animals, and many shelters ask residents to bring medications, identification, and basic personal supplies.

Shelter plans must be reviewed regularly. Contact numbers, building access procedures, and capacity limits can change over time. Keeping information current helps communities respond more effectively during severe weather events.

RC18-029

Question: What is the passage mainly about?

- A) Public storm shelters require clear and current information to help residents use them safely.
 - B) Storm shelters are used only for school events.
 - C) Residents should avoid learning shelter locations.
 - D) Severe weather plans never need review.
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RC18-030

Question: Where may public storm shelters be located?

- A) Schools, community centers, or specially built structures
 - B) Private grocery shelves only
 - C) Delivery trucks
 - D) Office filing cabinets
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RC18-031

Question: What items may residents be asked to bring?

- A) Medications, identification, and basic personal supplies
 - B) Construction tools and paint
 - C) Office printers and paper
 - D) Store advertising signs
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RC18-032

Question: Why must shelter plans be reviewed regularly?

- A) Contact numbers, access procedures, and capacity limits can change.
- B) Shelters never change location or rules.

- C) Residents always remember every instruction.
 - D) Severe weather cannot affect communities.
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Passage 8

An adult education center recently added short goal-setting meetings to its apprenticeship entrance-exam course. Instructors noticed that some students attended class regularly but did not know how to organize study time outside class.

During the meetings, students identify one or two specific goals for the week, such as completing a practice set, reviewing missed questions, or reading for twenty minutes each evening. Instructors help students choose goals that are realistic based on work schedules and family responsibilities.

The center does not expect every student to study the same way. Instead, the goal-setting meetings are meant to help students create a plan they can actually follow. Early feedback suggests that students feel more in control of their preparation.

RC18-033

Question: Why did the center add goal-setting meetings?

- A) Some students needed help organizing study time outside class.
 - B) Students stopped attending class regularly.
 - C) Instructors wanted to cancel practice sets.
 - D) The course no longer prepared students for entrance exams.
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RC18-034

Question: Which weekly goal is mentioned in the passage?

- A) Reading for twenty minutes each evening
 - B) Repairing classroom equipment
 - C) Writing company policies
 - D) Avoiding all missed questions
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RC18-035

Question: How do instructors help students choose goals?

- A) By making every student use the same plan
 - B) By basing goals on realistic schedules and responsibilities
 - C) By removing all outside study
 - D) By assigning only impossible goals
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RC18-036

Question: Which statement is best supported by the passage?

- A) Goal-setting can help adult students create study plans they can follow.
 - B) Students must all study in exactly the same way.
 - C) Weekly goals should ignore work and family responsibilities.
 - D) Study planning makes students less prepared.
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Part B — Answer Key + Explanations

RC18-001 — Correct: B — Explanation:

The passage focuses on how the online comfort request form made temperature concerns easier to record, track, and respond to.

RC18-002 — Correct: B — Explanation:

Under the old process, requests could be delayed or repeated because there was no single record of the issue.

RC18-003 — Correct: A — Explanation:

Employees enter the room number, concern, time noticed, and whether the issue affects a large area or one workspace.

RC18-004 — Correct: C — Explanation:

Maintenance staff compare reports from the same area to identify repeated problems or patterns.

RC18-005 — Correct: A — Explanation:

In context, “patterns” means repeated signs or trends, such as repeated complaints from one building section.

RC18-006 — Correct: A — Explanation:

The notice announces a procedure for handling printer paper jams safely and avoiding damage.

RC18-007 — Correct: C — Explanation:

Untrained employees should place an “out of service” sign on the printer and contact Office Support.

RC18-008 — Correct: A — Explanation:

The procedure was created because printers were damaged when users pulled stuck paper from the wrong area.

RC18-009 — Correct: B — Explanation:

Office Support will offer training to employees who regularly use the print room.

RC18-010 — Correct: A — Explanation:

The passage explains that incident trend reviews help companies identify repeated safety problems and reduce future risk.

RC18-011 — Correct: B — Explanation:

Trend reviews look for repeated types of problems across reports over time.

RC18-012 — Correct: A — Explanation:

The passage specifically says the company may review glove use, tool condition, training, or work pace.

RC18-013 — Correct: C — Explanation:

“Got hurt” is weak because it does not provide enough detail to identify the cause of the incident.

RC18-014 — Correct: A — Explanation:

The passage supports the idea that accurate details help managers find causes and prevent similar incidents.

RC18-015 — Correct: A — Explanation:

The passage explains how automatic irrigation timers improved watering schedules while still requiring inspection.

RC18-016 — Correct: C — Explanation:

Manual operation could lead to missed schedules or sprinklers running too long.

RC18-017 — Correct: A — Explanation:

Early morning watering can reduce evaporation and avoid interfering with visitors.

RC18-018 — Correct: B — Explanation:

The passage explains the older manual method, then the improvement from timers, and finally current maintenance needs.

RC18-019 — Correct: B — Explanation:

The passage focuses on how revised training helped call-center employees communicate better with upset customers.

RC18-020 — Correct: A — Explanation:

The previous training mainly focused on finding the correct department or policy.

RC18-021 — Correct: A — Explanation:

Supervisors noticed that some employees sounded rushed or defensive when customers were upset.

RC18-022 — Correct: A — Explanation:

Employees practice calm responses through short role-play conversations.

RC18-023 — Correct: B — Explanation:

In context, “defensive” means acting as if being criticized or attacked.

RC18-024 — Correct: A — Explanation:

The passage explains that color-coded tags help identify equipment status, but only if the tags are current.

RC18-025 — Correct: A — Explanation:

A red tag may show that equipment should not be used until repaired or inspected.

RC18-026 — Correct: B — Explanation:

Status tags help workers quickly decide whether equipment is available for use.

RC18-027 — Correct: A — Explanation:

If tags are not current, employees may receive the wrong message about whether equipment is safe or ready.

RC18-028 — Correct: A — Explanation:

The passage supports the conclusion that tag systems work only when tags match the actual equipment condition.

RC18-029 — Correct: A — Explanation:

The passage explains that storm shelters are useful only when residents have clear, current information about location, rules, and access.

RC18-030 — Correct: A — Explanation:

Shelters may be located in schools, community centers, or specially built structures.

RC18-031 — Correct: A — Explanation:

Residents may be asked to bring medications, identification, and basic personal supplies.

RC18-032 — Correct: A — Explanation:

Shelter plans need review because phone numbers, access procedures, and capacity limits can change.

RC18-033 — Correct: A — Explanation:

The center added goal-setting meetings because some students struggled to organize study time outside class.

RC18-034 — Correct: A — Explanation:

Reading for twenty minutes each evening is specifically listed as one possible weekly goal.

RC18-035 — Correct: B — Explanation:

Instructors help students choose realistic goals based on work schedules and family responsibilities.

RC18-036 — Correct: A — Explanation:

The passage supports the idea that goal-setting helps adult students create study plans they can actually follow.

Answer Summary

Question Answer

RC18-001 B

RC18-002 B

RC18-003 A

RC18-004 C

Question Answer

RC18-005 A

RC18-006 A

RC18-007 C

RC18-008 A

RC18-009 B

RC18-010 A

RC18-011 B

RC18-012 A

RC18-013 C

RC18-014 A

RC18-015 A

RC18-016 C

RC18-017 A

RC18-018 B

RC18-019 B

RC18-020 A

RC18-021 A

RC18-022 A

RC18-023 B

RC18-024 A

RC18-025 A

RC18-026 B

RC18-027 A

RC18-028 A

RC18-029 A

RC18-030 A

RC18-031 A

RC18-032 A

RC18-033 A

RC18-034 A

RC18-035 B

RC18-036 A